

A Parametric View on Exclusive Focus Particles

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1. Introduction

Language has two basic apparatuses for quantification (Partee 1991): **D-quantification** (e.g., determiner *every*) and **A-quantification** (e.g., adverb *always*). Remarkably, exclusive focus particles like *only* seem to allow for both. The adfocal use resembles D-quantification and the adverbial use resembles A-quantification (Horn 1969, Jackendoff 1972, Taglicht 1984, Rooth 1985, Büring & Hartmann 2001, *i.a.*):

- (1) a. John gave **only**_{adfoc} MARY a book. (adfocal/constituent/pre-DP *only*)
 b. John **only**_{adv} gave MARY a book. (adverbial/sentential/pre-vP *only*)

There is, however, a recent line of research attempting to reduce D-quantification to A-quantification (Kratzer & Shimoyama 2002, Kratzer 2005, Szabolcsi 2017, 2024, *cf.* Carlson 1983, 2006). The rationale behind this is that the surface position of the D-quantifiers does not always match with the expected scope position. In some cases, the (apparent) D-quantifiers may even be “doubled” with the A-quantifiers, but the meaning is interpreted as if there is only one quantificational element (e.g., negative concord, Labov 1972, Zanuttini 1991, Zeijlstra 2004, 2022, *i.a.*). For exclusive particles, it has been argued forcefully that the adfocal ones are not D-quantifiers, but concord particles that signal an exclusive operator, which is a sentential/propositional operator (i.e., A-quantifier) realized as either *only*_{adv} or a null operator OP_{EXCL} , as in (2). Dubbed as the Operator-Particle approach, this view has been prominent in English and languages with doubling of exclusive particles (henceforth **exclusive doubling**), like Dutch, German, Kasem, Korean, Mandarin, Vietnamese, among others (Bayer 1996, Lee 2005, Quek & Hirsch 2017, Bassi et al. 2022, Hirsch 2022, Sun 2021, Branan & Erlewine 2023, Yip 2025b, Aremu forthcoming, *i.a.*).

- (2) The Operator-Particle approach ($\boxed{}$ = the semantic import of exclusives)

$$[_{TP} \dots \underbrace{OP_{EXCL} / only_{adv}} [_{vP} \dots V [Prt / only_{adfoc} -DP_F]]]$$

In this study, I argue that such a view is too strong and *cannot* be universal. I propose that both D- and A-quantification strategies are available for exclusives, but the choice is *parameterized* in individual languages, which then shapes the landscape of variation in exclusive doubling. With novel fieldwork data, I will show that although Vietnamese falls into (2), Yorùbá displays the opposite pattern as in (3). The adfocal particle is a D-quantifier, whereas the adverbial particle does not carry exclusive semantics but appears to be a mere scope marker (*cf.* French *ne* in negative concord *ne...pas* ‘not’). I dub this view the Quantifier-Particle approach (see Yip & Adedjeji 2024). A battery of tests will be provided to differentiate between the exclusive semantic import from adverbial particles and from adfocal particles.

- (3) The Quantifier-Particle approach

$$[_{TP} \dots Prt [_{vP} \dots V [_{QP} \underbrace{QU_{EXCL}} -DP_F]]]$$

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Through a cross-linguistic survey, I further demonstrate that exclusive semantics may be encoded not only on (i) adverbial particles (as A-quantifiers, e.g., Vietnamese) and (ii) adfocal particles (as D-quantifiers, e.g., Yorùbá), but also on (iii) neither of them but rather a null operator, which I claim to be the case in Kasem (*pace* Aremu forthcoming), and on (iv) both adverbial and adfocal particles, which I argue to be attested in Mandarin (*pace* Sun 2021). Moreover, the four-way typology exhibits a striking parallelism with the typology of negative concord proposed by Biberauer & Zeijlstra (2012). The upshot is that quantification is available in both clausal and nominal domains.

The rest of the paper is organized as follows. §2 gives a background on exclusive doubling in Vietnamese and Yorùbá. §3 offers four diagnostics to pinpoint the import of exclusive semantics from the particles. §4 proposes the parametric view on exclusives, accounting for the variations. §5 concludes the paper by laying out the full typology paralleling negative concord.

Before proceeding, there is a note on data sources. The Vietnamese and Yorùbá data were collected from interview sessions with native speakers (n=33 for Vietnamese, fieldwork from 2023-2024 in Hanoi, Ho Chi Minh City, and Dalat; n=4 for Yorùbá, 2020 and 2023-2024, some reported in Yip & Adedeji 2024), with the rest cited from the literature.

2. Exclusive doubling in Vietnamese and Yorùbá

In Vietnamese, adverbial *chỉ* ‘only’ and adfocal *mỗi* ‘only’ can be doubled with the same focus association in (4) (Hole 2013, 2017, Erlewine 2017, Sun 2021, Yip 2025b). The truth condition is the same as if only one particle is used, i.e., a single-‘only’ but not a multi-‘only’ reading. While (4) appears to be a form-meaning mismatch, it is only apparent if we treat *chỉ* as semantically exclusive but not *mỗi* (Quek & Hirsch 2017, and the citations above).¹ Yorùbá similarly allows for exclusive doubling of adverbial *kàn* ‘only’ and adfocal *nìkan* ‘only’ (Yip & Adedeji 2024, Aremu 2025), as in (5). Unlike English and Vietnamese, adfocal *nìkan* attaches to the right of focus associates. As will be proposed, it is *nìkan* that is semantically exclusive, but not *kàn*. These particles are all associated with at-issue exclusiveness, which can be directly dissented by another speaker, negated, or questioned. For space reasons, I do not provide the relevant examples (but see §3.3 for some negation data).²

- (4) Nam {**chỉ**} [_{VP} tặng hoa cho [{**mỗi**} Lan_F]]. (chỉ; mỗi; chỉ ... mỗi)
 Nam only give flower to only Lan
 ‘Nam only gave flowers to Lan.’ (but not anyone else)
 NOT: ‘The only thing Nam did was giving flowers only to Lan.’, etc. [Vietnamese/VN]
- (5) Bode {**kàn**} [_{VP} fún [Adé_F {**nìkan**}] ní iwé]. (kàn; nìkan; kàn ... nìkan)
 Bode only give Ade only SEC book
 ‘Bode only gave Ade the book.’ (but not anyone else)
 NOT: ‘The only thing Bode did was giving the book only to Ade.’, etc. [Yorùbá/YO]

Exclusive doubling in both languages can be observed across clausal boundaries. Consider (6–7), where a narrow scope reading is obtained with embedded adverbial particles (=b), and a wide scope reading is obtained with matrix adverbial particles (=a). The latter case exemplifies long-distance doubling. Note also that without the adverbial particles, both readings are still possible (i.e., a scopal ambiguity).

- (6) Thầy giáo {a. **chỉ**} biết [_{CP} là Nam {b. **chỉ**} học **mỗi** [tiếng Pháp]_F]. [VN]
 teacher only know COMP Nam only study only French
 a. ‘The teacher only knows that Nam took French (, and didn’t know that Nam took English).’ (Wide scope: only>know)
 b. ‘The teacher knows that Nam only took French (, and knows that Nam didn’t take English).’ (Narrow scope: know>only)

1. Some speakers found using *mỗi* alone to be less natural (but still acceptable). They prefer to use it in doubling, or with an exclusive sentence-final particle (SFP) *thôi* ‘only’ (see Yip 2025b).

2. Abbreviations not in the Leipzig glossing rules: SEC=secundative preposition; SFP=sentence-final particle.

- (7) Olùkọ́ {a. **kàn**} mò [CP pé Adé {b. **kàn**} şe [German]_F **nìkàn**]. [YO]
 teacher only know COMP Ade only do German only
 a. 'The teacher only knows that Ade took *German*.' (Wide scope: only>know)
 b. 'The teacher knows that Ade only took *German*.' (Narrow scope: know>only)

Yet, wide scope becomes unavailable with a syntactic island boundary between the two particles, such as the complex NP island in (8) and the adjunct island in (9). The adfocal 'only' has embedded scope only. Adding adverbial 'only' in the matrix yields multi-'only' readings with a "sandwiched" scope *only* > *know* > *only*, suggesting the failure of exclusive doubling (which would lead to a single-'only' reading).

- (8) Thầy giáo {a. Ø/ b. **chỉ**} biết [DP tin [CP Nam học **mỗi** tiếng Pháp]]. [VN]
 teacher only know news Nam study only French
 a. ‘The teacher knows the news that Nam only took French (#but doesn’t know whether Nam took English).’ (Narrow scope: know>only)
 b. ‘The teacher only knows the news that Nam only took French (#but doesn’t know whether Nam took English).’ (Multi-‘only’: only>know>only)
- (9) Olùkọ nàà {a. Ø/ b. **kàn**} mò [CP pé [adjunct bí Adé bá ẹ German_F **nìkan**],
 teacher the only know COMP if Ade if do German only
 inú olùkọ German yòò dùn]. [YO]
 stomach teacher German will sweet
 a. ‘The teacher knows that if Ade only took German, the German teacher would be happy.’ (And the teacher knows it is otherwise if Ade also took French.) (Narrow scope: know>only)
 b. ‘The teacher only knows that if Ade only took German, the German teacher will be happy.’ (Multi-‘only’: only>know>only)

The island sensitivity, coupled with long-distance doubling, motivates covert movement, as in (10) (Sun 2021, Yip 2025b; *pace* Agree in Quek & Hirsch 2017, Hole 2017). In other words, Vietnamese and Yorùbá share in common a syntactic dependency between the adverbial and adfocal particles. In the following, however, we will see that they have drastically different semantic import. In Vietnamese, it is adverbial *chỉ* that carries exclusive semantics; whereas in Yorùbá it is adfocal *nìkan*.

- (10) Similar syntax: Covert movement in exclusive doubling
- a. [... **chi**_i [_{VP} ... **mōi**-DP_F ...]] [VN]
- b. [... **kàn** [_{VP} ... DP_F-**nìkan** ...]] [YO]

3. Differential semantic import

3.1. Backward association

As is well known, adverbial ‘only’ must c-command its focus associate and cannot associate “backward” with a moved focus, such as (11) in English (Jackendoff 1972, Tancredi 1990, Beaver & Clark 2008, Erlewine 2014; see Yip 2025a for Cantonese). Vietnamese conforms to this generalization. As in (12), adverbial *chỉ* fails to associate backward with the fronted object focus. It can only be interpreted as associating with the verbal focus (i.e., only *ate*). The pattern remains the same in exclusive doubling with adfocal *mỗi*.

- (11) a. John **only** met MARY_F at the party. (baseline)
 b. #MARY_F, John **only** met __ at the party. (meaning≠a) (topicalization; Erlewine 2014:11)
- (12) *Hôm qua (**mỗ**i) [thịt bò]_F Nam (mớ)i **chỉ** ăn __.
 yesterday only beef Nam just only eat
 Int.: ‘Nam only ate *beef* yesterday.’ [VN]

In contrast, Yorùbá adverbial *kàn* allows for backward association in (13) where the object undergoes focus movement marked by *ní* (see, e.g., Awóbùlùyì 1978, Aremu 2024 for *ní*), with or without adfocal

nìkan. This is unexpected if *kàn* were the exclusive operator subject to the Principle of Lexical Association (Tancredi 1990; cf. Erlewine 2014 for a copy-theoretic analysis on the ban of backward association).

- (13) [German]_F (**nìkan**) ni Akín **kàn** ɕe ____.
 German only FOC Akin only do
 ‘It is only *German* that Akin took.’ [YO]

3.2. Multiple association

The second test is whether the two particles may establish different focus association in the case of multiple foci. As seen in (14), when *mỗ* is moved out with the indirect object (IO) focus, *chỉ* may establish another association with the direct object (DO) within its scope. The resulting reading is a multi-‘only’ reading, with exclusive IO focus stacking on exclusive DO focus. The DO association follows from the operator status of *chỉ*. As for IO association with *mỗ*, a null OP_{EXCL} above is required, since backward association of *chỉ* with the IO is not possible.

- (14) **Mỗ** [Minh]_F (là) Nam **chỉ** tặng [hoa hồng]_F (thôi). (only-IO > only-DO)
 only Minh COP Nam only give rose SFP.only
 ‘M. is the only one who N. only gave *rose* to.’ (N. gave rose and lavender to other people.) [VN]

In Yorùbá, however, multiple association is not possible with *kàn* and *nìkan* in (15). This is surprising if *kàn* were the operator: with the absence of *nìkan*, it could associate with the object; but once *nìkan* attaches to the subject, *kàn* must associate with it, even though it is outside *kàn*’s scope. In other words, *kàn*’s focus association is dependent on *nìkan*. To achieve multiple association, two *nìkan* are needed.

- (15) a. Adé **kàn** máa-ní ka [àwọn ìwé Gẹ̀ẹ̀sì]_F. (only-Obj)
 Ade only HAB-PROG read PL book English
 ‘Ade only reads English books.’ (but not French books)
 b. [Adé]_{F1} **nìkan** ni ó **kàn** máa-ní ka [àwọn ìwé Gẹ̀ẹ̀sì]_(*F2). (only-Subj)
 Ade only FOC 3SG only HAB-PROG read PL book English
 ‘Ade is the only person who reads English books.’ (but not other people)
 c. [Adé]_{F1} **nìkan** ni ó (**kàn**) máa-ní ka [àwọn ìwé Gẹ̀ẹ̀sì]_{F2} **nìkan**. (S > O)
 Ade only FOC 3SG only HAB-PROG read PL book English only
 ‘Only Ade only reads English books.’ (others read both English and French books) [YO]

3.3. Scopal interaction with negation

The third one concerns whether the position of adverbial ‘only’ determines scope. In Vietnamese, *chỉ*’s position determines the relative scope with negation, as in (16).

- (16) a. Nam **chỉ** không học **mỗ** [tiếng Pháp]_F. b. Nam không **chỉ** học **mỗ** [tiếng Pháp]_F.
 Nam only not learn only French Nam not only learn only French
 ‘Nam only does not learn French.’ (only > ¬) ‘N. does not only learn Fr.’ (¬ > only) [VN]

In contrast, *kàn* in Yorùbá does not determine the scope with negation. In (17), both negators are higher than *kàn*, but negation takes wide scope over ‘only’ when preceding ex-situ focus, and narrow scope under ‘only’ following it, where *nìkan* can be pronounced. The scope appears to be determined by the position of the moved focus with *nìkan*.

- (17) a. kì-í ɕe German_F (**nìkan**) ni Adé **kàn** ɕe ____.
 NEG do German only FOC Ade only do
 ‘It is not only German that Ade takes.’ (¬ > only)
 b. German_F (**nìkan**) ni Adé kò **kàn** ɕe ____.
 German only FOC Ade NEG only do
 ‘It is only German that Ade didn’t take.’ (only > ¬) [YO]

3.4. Wide scope under ellipsis

The above tests contrast the behaviors of adverbial ‘only’ in scope and association. Nevertheless, even if adverbial ‘only’ is not the operator, it does not follow automatically that adfocal ‘only’ is the exclusive, since there can be a null OP_{EXCL} , which is independently needed in doubling cases. Crucially, OP_{EXCL} should share the properties of adverbial ‘only’, as convincingly shown by Bassi et al. (2022) for wide scope under ellipsis. This in turn serves as a powerful diagnostic of OP_{EXCL} . I unfold the argument below. First, adverbial *only* cannot associate into ellipsis site unless itself is also elided (Beaver & Clark 2008):

- (18) A. I **only** know he brought $WHITE_F$ wine. What about you? (Bassi et al. 2022:817)
 B1. *I **only** know he did ~~bring $WHITE_F$ wine~~, too. B2. I do ~~only know he brought $WHITE_F$ wine~~, too.

Second, *only*_{adfoc}’s wide scope does not survive ellipsis in (19). Bassi et al. (2022) propose that it follows from the failure of OP_{EXCL} to associate into ellipsis site in a wide scope configuration like (19d). Importantly, QR of D-quantifiers preserves the wide scope under ellipsis (Sag 1976, Fox 2000, Bassi et al. 2022), as in (20). Altogether, *only*_{adfoc} should not be a D-quantifier but a “concord” particle licensed by OP_{EXCL} .

- (19) a. Jill may bring **only**_{adfoc} WINE. ($\diamond > \text{only}$, $\text{only} > \diamond$) b. ... Bill may, too. ($\diamond > \text{only}$, $*\text{only} > \diamond$)
 c. [Bill [may $\langle OP_{EXCL} [\text{bring only wine}] \rangle$]]] d. *[Bill [OP_{EXCL} [may $\langle \text{bring only WINE} \rangle$]]]]
 (20) a. A boy is standing on **every** building. (every > a)
 b. A girl is, too. (every > a) (Bassi et al. 2022:816–820)

In Vietnamese, while *mỗi* may have wide scope above a modal like ‘may’ in (21a), it is not available under ellipsis in (21b), indicating the presence of OP_{EXCL} , just like English.

- (21) a. Nam có thể mang **mỗi** [rượu vang]_F. [VN]
 Nam may bring only wine
 i. ‘It’s allowed that N. only brings wine.’ ($\diamond > \text{only}$) ii. ‘N. may only bring wine.’ ($\text{only} > \diamond$)
 b. ... Lan cũng có thể.
 Lan also may
 ONLY: ‘... It is also allowed that Lan only brings wine.’ ($\diamond > \text{only}, * \text{only} > \diamond$)

Nevertheless, such asymmetry is not observed in Yorùbá. As in (20), both wide scope and narrow scope of ‘only’ are *retained* when *nikan* and the focus are elided, patterning with D-quantifiers with QR.

- (22) a. Olùkò nàà gba John láàyè [látí ɛ German_F **nikan**]. [YO]
 teacher the permit John give.chance to do German only
 i. ‘The teacher allows John to only take German.’ ($\diamond > \text{only}$)
 ii. ‘The teacher only allows John to take German.’ ($\text{only} > \diamond$)
 b. ... Olùkò gba Mary nàà láàyè.
 teacher permit Mary as.well give.chance
 i. ‘The teacher also allows Mary to only take German.’ ($\diamond > \text{only}$)
 ii. ‘The teacher also only allows Mary to take German.’ ($\text{only} > \diamond$)

4. Parametric variations in exclusive doubling

To account for the differential semantic import, I propose that whether a language adopts D- or A-quantification for exclusives is parameterized. Adverbial *chĩ* in Vietnamese is an exclusive A-quantifier (one-place propositional OP), whereas adfocal *nikan* in Yorùbá is a two-place D-quantifier:

- (23) a. $\llbracket chĩ \rrbracket(ALT) = \lambda p \lambda w : p(w). \forall q[(q \in ALT \wedge q(w)) \rightarrow p \subseteq q]$ (A-quant., after Rooth 1992)
 b. $\llbracket nikan \rrbracket = \lambda x \lambda P \lambda w. \forall y[P(y)(w) \rightarrow y = x]$ (D-quantification, after Rooth 1985)³

As for *mỗi* and *kàn*, I suggest that they do not have truth conditional effects, though they might encode

3. (23b) is simplified. One may adopt Coppock & Beaver 2014’s entry type-shifted from a propositional operator.

scalarity (Hole 2017 and Yip & Adedeji 2024, see also Aremu 2025), on the not-at-issue dimension (*cf.* Yip 2024). For simplicity, I treat them as identity functions here:

- (24) a. $\llbracket m\tilde{o}i \rrbracket = \lambda x.x$ b. $\llbracket k\tilde{a}n \rrbracket = \lambda p.p$

The test results in §3 fall out from this parametric view. Backward association is possible only in Yorùbá because *kàn* is never an exclusive, and does not actually establish its own focus association. This also immediately explains the contrast in multiple association, which can only be achieved by multiple *nikan* as *nikan* is the true exclusive. In contrast, Vietnamese *chỉ* is an exclusive operator. It establishes another association in multiple focus cases and observes the c-command requirement that bans backward association. The scopal facts follow, as well: adfocal *nikan* and adverbial *chỉ* both carry quantificational force and thus determine scope. When *nikan* is not pronounced, there is a null counterpart QU_{EXCL} , analogous to OP_{EXCL} except that it is a D-quantifier. Since *nikan* is a D-quantifier, its wide scope by QR survives ellipsis, unlike operator *chỉ* or OP_{EXCL} which fails to associate into ellipsis site.

To illustrate, the semantic compositions of doubling cases are given in (25) and (26).

- (25) a. Nam **chỉ** $[_{VP}$ tặng hoa cho $[m\tilde{o}i Lan_F]$. (reproduced from (4)) [VN]
 Nam only give flower to only Lan ‘Nam only gave flowers to *Lan*.’
 b. $[_{TP} chỉ [_{VP} Nam [‘gave’ [‘flowers’ [‘to’ $[_{DP} m\tilde{o}i Lan_F]$]]]]]$
 c. $\llbracket DP \rrbracket^o = I$; $\llbracket DP \rrbracket^{ALT} = \{I, g, n, \dots\}$
 d. $\llbracket vP \rrbracket^o = \wedge n \text{ gave flowers to } l$; $\llbracket vP \rrbracket^{ALT} = \{\wedge n \text{ gave flowers to } l, \wedge n \text{ gave flowers to } g, \dots\}$
 e. $\llbracket TP \rrbracket^o = \lambda w. \forall q [q \in \llbracket vP \rrbracket^{ALT} \wedge q(w) \rightarrow \llbracket vP \rrbracket^o \subseteq q] \rightsquigarrow$ Nam only gave flower to *Lan*
- (26) a. Bòdé **kàn** $[_{VP}$ fún $[Adé_F nikan]$ ní ìwé]. (reproduced from (5)) [YO]
 Bode only give Ade only SEC book ‘Bode only gave *Ade* the book.’
 b. $[_{TP} [_{QP} Adé nikan] [_{vP'} \lambda I [_{vP} k\tilde{a}n [Bòdé [‘gave’ [t_1 [‘the book’]]]]]]]$
 c. $\llbracket vP' \rrbracket = \lambda y. \text{gave}(tbook)(y)(b)$
 d. $\llbracket QP \rrbracket = \lambda P \lambda w. \forall y [P(y)(w) \rightarrow y = a]$
 e. $\llbracket TP \rrbracket = \lambda w. \forall y [\llbracket vP' \rrbracket (y)(w) \rightarrow y = a] \rightsquigarrow$ Bode only gave *Ade* the book

5. Conclusion: Towards a four-way typology

Extending the parameterization, we expect some languages to have both adverbial and adfocal particles semantically exclusive, and some other to have neither of them exclusive, giving a four-way typology in (27). Vietnamese is Type I with A-quantifiers and Yorùbá is Type II with D-quantifiers. English is also Type I, applying the four diagnostics. Yet, it disallows doubling, presumably due to a morphological constraint (see Quek & Hirsch 2017). As I will argue, Kasem belongs to Type III, where only a null OP_{EXCL} is employed; and Mandarin belongs to Type IV, where both (overt) A- and D-quantifiers are recruited.

- (27) The four-way typology of parametric variations in exclusives
- | | |
|--|--|
| Type I. Doubling, adverbial particle = OP_{EXCL} | Type III. Doubling, $OP_{EXCL} = \text{null}$ |
| $\boxed{OP_{EXCL}} [_{vP} \dots \text{Prt-XP}_F]$ | $\boxed{OP_{EXCL} - \emptyset} \dots \text{Prt} [_{vP} \dots \text{Prt-XP}_F]$ |
| (Vietnamese, English) | (Kasem) |
| Type II. Doubling, adfocal particle = QU_{EXCL} | Type IV. No doubling, with OP_{EXCL} & QU_{EXCL} |
| $\text{Prt} [_{vP} \dots \boxed{QU_{EXCL}} - \text{XP}_F]$ | $\boxed{OP_{EXCL}} [_{vP} \dots \boxed{QU_{EXCL}} - \text{XP}_F]$ |
| (Yorùbá) | (Mandarin) |

Like Yorùbá, Kasem adverbial *weeni* ‘only’ allows backward association as in (28a). On the other hand, multiple adfocal *yerane* ‘only’ does not give rise to a multi-‘only’ reading: (28b) has a single-‘only’ reading associating with an ordered pair <Adam, rice>, the unique pair that satisfies the eating relation. I propose that both *weeni* and *yerane* are not exclusive (*pace* Aremu forthcoming), and exclusivity comes from a null operator OP_{EXCL} , which also cannot associate into ellipsis site (Aremu forthcoming: §3.2).

- (28) a. Chwor_{oF} (**yerane**) mo Adam **weeni** o goa —. [KS]
 fowl only FOC Adam only 3SG kill.COMPL
 ‘Adam only slaughtered a fowl. (and nothing else)’ (Aremu forthcoming, ex.35b)
- b. Adam_F **yerane** mo di mumuna_F **yerane**. (only <Adam, rice> ∈ [eat])
 Adam only FOC eat rice only
 ‘No one ate anything, except that Adam ate rice.’ (Aremu forthcoming, ex.30)

Finally, I suggest that Mandarin exemplifies Type IV, where both particles are exclusive (*pace* Sun 2021). Hence, no doubling is possible as in (29a), and scope is determined by adverbial *zhi* ‘only’ (=29b) and adverbial *zhiyou* ‘only’ (see Sun 2021:333) together.

- (29) a. *Ta **zhi/zhishi** **zhiyou** [niurou]_F cai chi. [MC]
 3SG only/only.be only beef just eat
 Int.: ‘S/he only/just eats beef.’
- b. Zhangsan {**a. zhi**} **keyi** {**b. zhi**} chi [niurou]_F.
 Zhangsan only may only eat beef
 ‘Zhangsan may eat only beef.’ (a. only > ◇; b. ◇ > only)

Zooming out, the exclusive typology (27) is reminiscent of Biberauer & Zeijlstra (2012)’s view on negative concord. They show that sentential negative markers and n-words also display parametric variations: semantic negation may be on neg-markers, n-words, neither, or both:

- (30) Biberauer & Zeijlstra (2012) typology of negative concord
- | | |
|---|---|
| a. <i>Non-strict NC, only neg-markers</i> = ¬ | c. <i>Strict NC, both neg-markers & N-words</i> ≠ ¬ |
| $\boxed{\text{Neg}_{[i\text{NEG}]}} [\text{VP} \dots n_{[i\text{NEG}]} \text{-NP}]$ | $\boxed{\text{OP}_{\neg[i\text{NEG}]}} \dots \text{Neg}_{[i\text{NEG}]} [\text{VP} \dots n_{[i\text{NEG}]} \text{-NP}]$ |
| (Spanish, Italian, Portuguese) | (Czech, Serbo-Croatian, Greek, Afrikaans B) |
| b. <i>NC, only N-words</i> = ¬ | d. <i>DN: both neg-markers and N-words</i> = ¬ |
| $\text{Neg}_{[i\text{NEG}]} [\text{VP} \dots \boxed{n_{[i\text{NEG}]}} \text{-NP}]$ | $\boxed{\text{Neg}_{[i\text{NEG}]}} [\text{VP} \dots \boxed{n_{[i\text{NEG}]}} \text{-NP}]$ |
| (Afrikaans A) | (Dutch, German, Swedish) |

The parallel suggests that quantification is possible in both clausal domains and nominal domains, but the choice is parameterized in individual languages. There are, of course, intriguing questions on whether the choice made by a language is general to all domains of quantification or just one, and why such choice is made. These questions, however, must await another occasion for full exploration.

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